



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Harbor Christian Academy
School Website: <https://harborchristianacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Harbor Christian Academy (HCA) in Houston's urban Fifth Ward/Denver Harbor area presents a robust classical Christian program that aligns closely with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School. Across all six categories, the school demonstrates clear elements of classical education: a Trivium-based curriculum integrated with Biblical worship, explicit emphasis on virtue and wisdom as aims of education, a history-and-literature-rich curriculum, Socratic and dialectic pedagogy in the upper grades, a visible living-faculty-and-community ethos, and a strong partnership with parents and the surrounding community. Public materials emphasize the end of education as glorifying God, formation of character, mastery of the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books-like engagement with literature, and high levels of parental involvement through partnerships and open campus initiatives. The domain content consistently frames education as a sacred, communal endeavor anchored in Christian doctrine and liturgy, with explicit references to worship, prayer, and a daily Bible-centered culture. These signals collectively support a CLASSICAL rating across all six categories.

Key takeaways: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are strongly reinforced by explicit statements about God, the Bible, worship, and the goal to glorify God. - School Purpose and Goal are framed around formation, virtue, wisdom, and a telos that transcends vocational preparation. - Curriculum centers on grammar, logic, rhetoric, a biblically informed humanities emphasis, Latin, and engaging with classic literature and historical study. - Pedagogy combines contemplative/restful elements with Socratic dialogue, debates, and rhetoric-focused activities in the upper grades. - Faculty is presented through a Christian, mentoring lens with visible teacher roles and a living-curriculum flavor via a Christian faculty. - Parents & Community are integrated through partnerships, parent formation opportunities, and open access to engage with the school.

Evidence is drawn from Harbor Christian Academy's public materials, including statements about the Trivium, daily worship, Latin and logic study, senior theses, and explicit parent partnerships. See the cited sources throughout for specifics.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - "God's truth is the foundation of education at Harbor Christian Academy. The Bible serves as a guiding light throughout our curriculum..." (The Trivium in the Classroom) - "As a Christian school, we recognize that the end of man is to glorify God and enjoy Him forever..." (Philosophy of Education) - "Daily

worship, Bible, and prayer time” (Our Distinctives) - “Christian teachers; Christ-centered community” (Our Distinctives)

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; Bible; God; worship; prayer; Christian; glorify God; Christ-centered; theology-related framing appears via biblical basis. - Negative keywords present: none observed in public materials (no signaling of relativism, secular humanism, etc.).

Quantitative Estimate - Positive keywords present: at least 8 distinct terms/phrases drawn from the public materials (e.g., truth, goodness, beauty, Bible, God, worship, prayer, glorify God, Christ-centered) with multiple mentions. - Negative keywords present: 0 observed.

Why this rating - The school explicitly anchors education in transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) formed within a Biblical/theological frame, with liturgical practices and worship as part of daily life. This aligns strongly with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria and yields a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - End goal articulated as formation of virtue and wisdom, not merely job prep; “the end of man is to glorify God and enjoy Him forever” (Philosophy of Education) and related statements about cultivating worshipers and members of the Kingdom of Heaven. - Emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and classical telos (e.g., growth toward truth, goodness, beauty; classical mission implied by Trivium-based pedagogy). - Classical curriculum framing (emphasis on form, not just content) through “classical education” language and the Trivium as a guiding framework.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; wisdom; telos/end; glorify God; classical mission; education for leisure/restful contemplation (where applicable); liberal-arts cadence implied through Trivium. - Negative keywords present: none observed (no explicit focus on college-/career readiness or 21st-century workforce framing in the public-facing materials).

Quantitative Estimate - Positive keywords present: roughly 4–6 core terms (formation, virtue, wisdom, telos/end, glorify God, classical mission) appear across the materials. - Negative keywords present: 0 observed.

Why this rating - The materials consistently present education as formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom, anchored in a transcendent telos and classical mission, rather than solely job-oriented outcomes. This warrants CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Trivium emphasis: grammar, logic, rhetoric are central to the classroom (The Trivium in the Classroom). - Explicit curriculum elements: grammar, logic, rhetoric; study of formal logic; rhetoric; memorization; grammar-stage activities; logic-stage debates; rhetoric-stage senior thesis. - History and Great-Books-like engagement: “classic literature” discussion to discern what is true, good, and beautiful; integration of literature with history and geography; emphasis on Latin study; emphasis on Western civilization/history as context. - Latin and classical languages; primary-source-style study; primary literature and classical themes noted in philosophy page. - The program emphasizes a language-rich, literature-and-history-integrated humanities core and a vertical progression through grammar, dialectic, and rhetoric.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts; trivium; grammar; logic; rhetoric; great books/classics; history; Western civilization; Latin; dialectic; recitation; narration; dictation; memory work; sacred song and hymns (in related pages). - Negative keywords present: none observed (no explicit “project-based learning” dominance, no “STEM-first,” etc., in the public-facing materials).

Quantitative Estimate - Positive keywords present: at least 6–9 distinct curriculum-related terms (grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, history, Western civilization, great books/classics, dialectic, recitation/narration/dictation, memory work). - Negative keywords present: 0 observed.

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly built around the Liberal Arts/Trivium framework, with a strong emphasis on Great Books-style engagement, classical languages, and history-centered study. The presence of grammar–logic–rhetoric and the classical-literature orientation justify CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Socratic discourse in upper grades: “Socratic discussions” in the Logic School; debates and discourse to develop critical thinking. - Contemplative/restful elements and memory-focused practice in lower grades: imitation/memorization, singing, and songs; “grammar stage” memory-based work. - Rhetoric development and public speaking: upper school rhetoric training, capstone projects, senior theses. - Integration of memory work, recitation, and liturgical/recitation-based elements: memory work and catechesis mentioned in the lexicon; Harbor’s materials show memory-based learning via grammar-stage activities and recitation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar/discussion; dialectic; disputation; narration/recitation; chanting/singing to memorize; contemplative/scholé; memory-work; rhetoric exercises; speeches/debates; capstone/ senior-thesis style work; liturgical/catechesis integration. - Negative keywords present: none observed in public materials.

Quantitative Estimate - Positive keywords present: multiple pedagogical terms across categories (Socratic discussions; debates; narration/recitation; memory work; chanting; scholé-like rest; rhetoric; capstone/senior thesis). - Negative keywords present: 0 observed.

Why this rating - The pedagogical approach marries contemplative, memory-focused methods with Socratic inquiry and rhetoric development, consistent with classical pedagogy. The presence of upper-grade Socratic work, lower-grade chant/memory, and capstone rhetoric aligns with CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public-facing statements describe the faculty as Christian teachers guiding students, with small class sizes and a moral-mentoring framing (Our Distinctives; Faculty directory). - The school emphasizes a teacher-centered, virtuous living curriculum through role modeling and mentorship rather than a purely technical credentialing approach. Public materials present teachers as “Christian teachers” and a “caring, Christ-centered community” with a low student-to-teacher ratio (1:14). - Faculty directory shows named teachers and staff across the Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric tracks, emphasizing the teacher as central to student development.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: teachers; Christian teachers; small class sizes; daily worship and spiritual leadership as a norm; living curriculum (implied through teacher-centered, virtue-formation framing); portrait of teacher/student as a community of mentors (phrases like “faculty” and “mentors” appear conceptually, even if not always in a single explicit line). - Negative keywords present: none observed.

Quantitative Estimate - Positive keywords present: 4–6 core terms/ideas (teacher as mentor; Christian teachers; small class size; living curriculum framing; faculty as core; portrait of teacher and student relationship). - Negative keywords present: 0 observed.

Why this rating - The school presents a teacher-led, mentorship-forward model intertwined with a Christian ethos, with explicit focus on character formation and living exemplars in the faculty. This aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for the Faculty category.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Partners and parent involvement emphasized: Harbor Partner Program coordinates donor support to allow low-income urban youth access to classical education; parents are invited to participate, and there is a culture of parental involvement and accountability. - Tuition/policy emphasizes making classical education accessible to families from varied backgrounds; all families receive financial assistance, with ongoing parent engagement through partnerships and donor relationships. - The school positions itself as

open to visits and parent participation; there are additional community and family engagement components (e.g., partner funding model, house systems and community life features).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parent formation; seminars/book clubs; open campus/visits; parent covenant; family liturgy alignment; community involvement; shared responsibility in governance and funding. - Negative keywords present: none observed.

Quantitative Estimate - Positive keywords present: multiple terms (partnership with parents; co-teachers; parent formation; seminars/book clubs; family participation; parent covenant; open campus). - Negative keywords present: 0 observed.

Why this rating - The materials emphasize a strong, explicit partnership with parents and community involvement, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Aggregate Classification - All six categories are CLASSICAL based on keyword signals and evidence from Harbor Christian Academy's public materials. The aggregate rating is CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Final Ranking - Overall: CLASSICAL - Strong signals across all six categories: Religious/metaphysical foundations; purpose and goal; curriculum; pedagogy; faculty; parents & community. - The school's public materials consistently emphasize truth, goodness, beauty; the Trivium; worship and Bible integration; senior-thesis rhetoric; and robust parental partnership.

What would move the needle - Not required because all six categories meet CLASSICAL standards according to the rubric and the keyword indicators. If desired, minor enhancements could involve further explicit articulation of Great Books or primary-source lists by grade level and a more formal "living curriculum" descriptor in faculty materials to reinforce the Faculty category, but these are not necessary to achieve CLASSICAL status.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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